

EVIDENCE ROOM

PROFESSIONAL · AGENT LIBRARY

Agent Charter Standard

Evidence Room · AP Agent OS · Pro
Document ID: ER-APOS-LIB-CS
Version: 1.0 · September 2026
Classification: Licensed material
Companion: 00_AGENT_STACK_OVERVIEW.md · RESPONSIBILITY_MODEL.md

1. Why a standard exists

Sixteen agents will drift unless they are written to the same contract. This document is that contract. Every file A01–A16 must contain every required section, filled with AP-specific content — not a restatement of this standard.

A charter is the answer to seven questions. Each section must answer at least one of them. If a section answers none, delete it or rewrite it.

QUESTION	TYPICAL SECTIONS
What should I do?	Purpose, job description, responsibilities, output standard
How?	Inputs, tools/systems, failure handling, worked example
Who owns it?	Human owner, approval requirements, escalation
What can go wrong?	Explicit exclusions, failure handling, escalation
How do I control it?	Control requirements, approval by level, exclusions
How do I measure it?	KPIs, performance history, cost monitoring
What evidence proves it works?	Audit evidence, output standard, performance history

2. File rules

RULE	REQUIREMENT
Location	/workspace/evidence-room/03_AP_AGENT_05_PRO/Agent_Library/
Filename	Axx_snake_case_name.md matching the index in the overview
Length	250–450 lines. Shorter is incomplete. Longer is not editing.
Voice	Intelligent, concise, executive, finance-native. No hype.
Claims	No guaranteed savings, cycle-time, exception, fraud, compliance, or ROI.
Statistics	Invent none. Cite Ardent Partners 2024 Best-in-Class (78% lower cost, 82% faster cycle, 59% lower exceptions, 9% exception rate) or Forrester March 2025 AI AP use cases (capture, matching, reporting, fraud management, payment management, e-invoicing/ tax), or label Evidence Room framework / illustrative .
Worked example	Always Northline Industrial Group (fictional: 4,200 employees, ~18,000 invoices/ month, SAP S/4HANA + one NetSuite entity, 14-person shared-services AP team). Never a real employer or client.
ERP	Agnostic. Name SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, and “other” in the tools section.
Autonomy	Starting level is 0 or 1 unless the overview records a written exception (there are none in v1.0).
Cross-refs	Use agent IDs (A03) and reason codes (GR-MISS) from the overview taxonomy.

3. Required header block

Every charter opens with this table. Values are instance data, not copies of the standard.

```
# Axx – <Agent name>

| Field | Value |
|---|---|
| Agent ID | Axx |
| Name | <full name> |
| Domain | Invoice-to-pay / AP |
| Forrester (Mar 2025) map | <capture / matching / reporting / fraud management / payment management> |
| Starting autonomy | Level 0 or Level 1 |
| Human owner (role) | <role> |
| Backup owner (role) | <role> |
| Dispatcher | A16 |
```

| Product | Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Pro |
 | Charter version | 1.0 · September 2026 |

4. Required sections (normative)

A charter that omits a section is not implementation-ready. Section numbers below are the product standard. Keep them so Internal Audit and implementers can diff agents.

4.1 Purpose

One sentence. Name the job and the boundary.

Fail: “Uses AI to streamline AP.”

Pass: “Capture inbound invoices from every live channel, extract a structured header and lines, and create a parked work object for validation — without posting or paying.”

4.2 Job description

A hiring-grade description: scope, daily rhythm, neighbours (which agents it calls and which call it), and what “done” means at Level 0 vs Level 1. One to four short paragraphs plus a scoped / not-scoped list.

Must state the document population (PO, non-PO, recurring, credit notes, intercompany, employee expenses — in or out).

4.3 Inputs / required data

Table of required vs optional fields, source system, and what happens if missing (HDR-ERR, hard stop, or degrade). Include inbound-channel list where relevant. Include the work-object fields consumed from upstream agents.

Minimum columns: Data, Required?, Source, If missing.

4.4 Tools / systems

ERP-agnostic mapping table with at least: SAP S/4HANA, D365, Oracle Fusion, NetSuite, Workday, Other. Plus capture, tax, mail, workflow, and bank tools where the job needs them.

State **read** vs **write** vs **write-never**. Payment file and bank-detail writes are write-never for every agent except the human payments process.

4.5 Responsibilities

Numbered. Each item is an action the agent performs at its *current default starting level*, with a note on what changes at Level 2+. Prefer verbs finance recognises: park, match, age, accrue, reconcile, chase, challenge, escalate.

4.6 Explicit exclusions

The “must NEVER” list. Mandatory inclusions for every agent:

- Never release a payment, bank file, or positive-pay file.
- Never conclude fraud.
- Never grant itself a higher autonomy level.
- Never invent a tolerance, tax position, or write-off.
- Never use real client/employer data in examples or prompts shipped with the product.

Then add job-specific exclusions (A10 never silently deletes a suspected duplicate; A08 never changes vendor bank details without the configured human approval; A13 never signs the close).

4.7 Human owner

Named **role**, backup role, and the decision rights that cannot be delegated to the agent. Name the Northline person only in the worked example, not as a product default.

4.8 Approval requirements by autonomy level

A five-row table (Levels 0–4) with: what the agent may do, what the human must approve, and the artefact that proves approval. Copy the responsibility model; do not soften it.

4.9 Escalation criteria

Hard triggers (value, age, reason code, SOD, completeness break) and where the object goes (role + agent). Include the A16 path. Include a “do not escalate” line for noise.

4.10 Output standard

Exact artefacts: object types, filenames or report IDs, field lists, and “done” criteria. An implementer should be able to build the object without a workshop.

4.11 Control requirements

Policy versions, SOD, sampling, change control, completeness, untrusted-input handling. Tie to the stack spine in the overview.

4.12 Audit evidence to retain

What Internal Audit can pull, from where, for how long (state “follow local financial-record retention; do not assume a year count”). Include override classification and envelope-break logs.

4.13 KPIs

Four families. No vanity metrics.

FAMILY	QUESTION
Activity	Did it touch the work?
Operational	Did the process move?
Financial	Did money move correctly?
Risk	Did controls hold?

Each KPI needs: **name, formula, source, cadence, owner, promotion relevance**. If you cannot name the source system, drop the KPI.

4.14 Performance history fields

The data model for the monthly score. Include the stack-common fields plus agent-specific fields. These fields are what A16 reads at promotion review.

4.15 Starting autonomy level

Restate the default, the envelope (if any — usually none at start), and the first promotion target. Link to `RESPONSIBILITY_MODEL.md`. Do not invent a Level 2 start.

4.16 Failure handling

Table of failure modes: extract garbage, ERP timeout, ambiguous vendor, mail bounce, model outage, conflicting ledger vs extract, poison PDF. For each: detect, degrade, notify, resume.

4.17 Cost monitoring

Unit costs the owner must see: compute/API per object, human minutes, false-positive hours, rework documents, idle running. Who reports (usually A14) and who acts.

4.18 Worked example — Northline Industrial Group

A specific document or week, with fictional IDs and amounts, showing:

- the trigger
- the objects created
- the human action at the starting level
- what would have been illegal at a higher level
- the artefact names
- one thing that goes wrong and how it is controlled

Do not use a real company. Do not imply Northline is a customer.

5. Optional but recommended blocks

Use when they add control or implementation value. Do not add them as decoration.

BLOCK	USE WHEN
Decision table	Matching, triage, payment challenge, close
State machine	Objects with waiting-external states (A05, A08, A09, A11)
Reason-code subset	Agent owns a slice of the taxonomy
Channel list	A01, A08, A14
Sample plan	Any agent proposed for Level 3 later
Cross-ledger notes	Population exists in more than one book (Northline SAP + NetSuite)

6. Shared field libraries (copy, then specialise)

6.1 Common performance-history fields

Every agent includes at least:

```
period_id
agent_id
source_system
company_code
autonomy_level_in_force
objects_in_population
objects_touched
recommendations_issued
recommendations_accepted
recommendations_edited
recommendations_rejected
overrides_agent_error
overrides_policy
overrides_missing_data
overrides_preference
false_positives
false_negatives_known
escalations
envelope_breaks
unauthorised_level_attempts
human_minutes
agent_compute_cost
sample_n
sample_defects
kill_switch_events
review_date
```

6.2 Common work-object header

```
object_id
object_type
source_system
source_doc_id
company_code
vendor_id
vendor_alias
amount
currency
due_date
reason_code
autonomy_level_in_force
recommended_action
confidence
evidence_refs[]
human_owner
sla_due
state
parent_object_id
created_by_agent
updated_at
```

6.3 Forbidden vanity metrics

Do not put these in a charter KPI table:

- Number of AI conversations / messages / “insights generated”
 - Unanchored “accuracy %” (no denominator, no gold set)
 - “Hours saved” without a measured baseline and a method
 - “Fraud prevented \$” that counts *suspected* anomalies
 - “Compliance achieved” as a boolean
 - NPS of the agent
 - Token count as a success metric (token count is a **cost** metric)
-

7. Conformance checklist (print at the end of each charter)

Every A01–A16 file ends with this checklist, ticked for that file:

- ☐ Purpose is one sentence and names a boundary
- ☐ Job description names population in / out
- ☐ Inputs table has required/optional and “if missing”
- ☐ Tools table covers SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, Other, and read/write
- ☐ Responsibilities are verbs at the starting level
- ☐ Exclusions include payment release, fraud conclusion, self-promotion
- ☐ Human owner is a role with a backup
- ☐ Levels 0–4 approval table is present and not softer than the responsibility model
- ☐ Escalation has hard triggers and a do-not-escalate line
- ☐ Outputs are named artefacts with fields
- ☐ Controls include SOD, completeness, change control, untrusted input
- ☐ Audit evidence is pullable
- ☐ KPIs cover activity / operational / financial / risk and name a source
- ☐ Performance history includes the common fields
- ☐ Starting autonomy is 0 or 1
- ☐ Failure handling has detect / degrade / notify / resume
- ☐ Cost monitoring is present
- ☐ Northline example is fictional and specific
- ☐ No guaranteed savings / fraud / compliance / ROI claim
- ☐ Statistics cited or labelled illustrative

A16 may refuse to mark an agent “configurable” until this list is true.

8. Change control for charters

CHANGE	WHO APPROVES
Clarifying text, examples, ERP aliases	Product + AP Manager (customer copy)
New exclusion or tighter starting level	AP Manager (always allowed)
Looser starting level or removed exclusion	Controller — discouraged; not in product default
New reason code	AP Manager + A16 taxonomy owner
KPI definition change	AP Manager + Controls (breaks history)
Envelope template change	Same as autonomy level that uses it

Customer copies of charters are versioned. The licensed product files remain the Evidence Room default.

9. Northline names used across charters (fictional)

Use these consistently. Do not expand into a real org chart.

NAME	ROLE
Priya Menon	AP Manager (A16 owner)
Maya Chen	Intake processor (A01)
Diego Alvarez	Matching lead (A02/A03)
Marcus Hale	Exception lead (A04/A09)
Tomoko Sato	Payments lead (A12)
Hannah Cole	Reconciliations & close (A11/A13)
Samuel Wright	Controls / quality (A10)
Lina Park	Vendor master (A08)
Owen Briggs	Warehouse liaison (A05)
Greta Holm	Procurement operations (A06)

NAME	ROLE
Elena Voss	Assistant Controller (A13 sign-off)
Illustrative vendors: Helion Fasteners NA, Cinder River Logistics, Quay Chemical, Oakbridge Facilities, Veston IT, Pacific Castings (NetSuite entity supplier). Illustrative company codes: NL10, NL20, NL30 (SAP); NPC (NetSuite — Northline Pacific Components).	

10. Document control

ITEM	VALUE
Owner	Evidence Room — AP Agent OS product
Related testing	../Testing uses this standard as the charter review checklist
Advice status	Not legal, tax, accounting, or investment advice

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